You can interpret this output as shown in figure 8.5. The leader node has switched to Up and is ready to accept other nodes. The role of the leader node is to manage the convergence of the cluster and the membership transitions. Only one node can be the leader at any time, and any cluster node can become the leader.

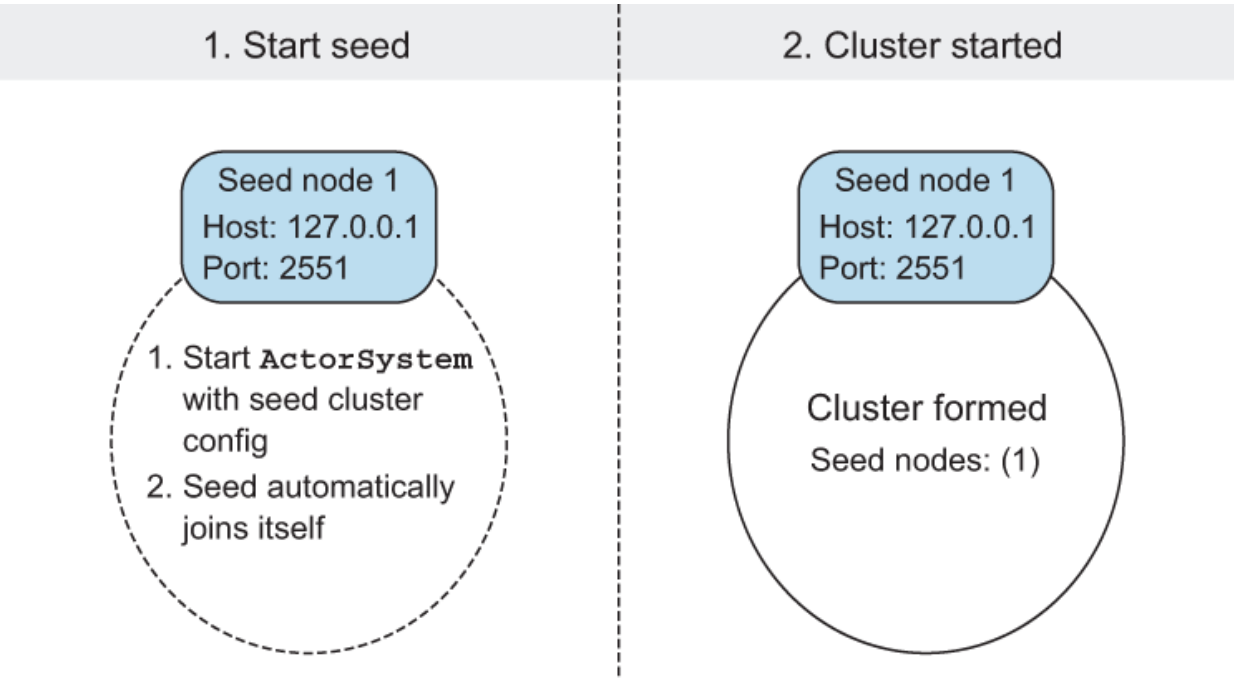


Figure 8.5 The initial seed node joins itself and forms the cluster.

You can now do the same thing to start two more nodes on two other terminals: just change the ports to 2552 and 2553. Adding a node on port 2552 looks like this:

```
sbt -DPORT=2552 chapter08a/console

scala> :paste
// Entering paste mode (ctrl-D to finish)
import akka.actor.typed.ActorSystem
import akka.actor.typed.scaladsl.Behaviors

val guardian = ActorSystem(Behaviors.empty, "words")
```